



BMW in the scooter market

Two premium scooters and an electric version in the offing
<http://bit.ly/vMJwVp>

Huawei Honor in February

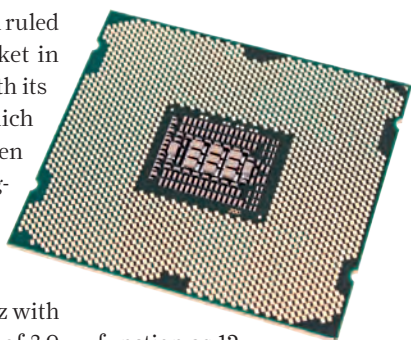
Huawei Honor is reportedly arriving in India by February 2012, with an Android 4.0 ICS update onboard.
<http://bit.ly/suaZv2>

Bazaar

Intel Core i7-3960X

The Bugatti Veyron of desktop processors

Intel has pretty much ruled the processor market in the year gone by with its Core i7-2600K, which could not be defeated even by the eight-core AMD flagship FX-8150. The Sandy Bridge E processor – the Core i7-3960X running at a clock speed of 3.3 GHz with a max Turbo frequency of 3.9 GHz, with a shared L3 cache of 15MB, looks great on paper. There are lot of common aspects from the Sandy Bridge microarchitecture that have been carried forward. A base clock BCLK running at 100 MHz which is also used by the integrated memory controller, system agent, etc. There are a total of six active cores on the die, which



function as 12 threads thanks to Intel Hyperthreading. You will need a new socket – LGA 2011 to house the SBE processor and the motherboard with the X79 chipset.

Prominent by its absence is the integrated graphics die, which also lets go of the Quick Sync Video transcoding feature.

We tested the processor on an ASUS Rampage IV Extreme

board with Kingston 8 GB DDR3 RAM, AMD HD 6850 graphics card and a Cooler Master GX 650W power supply. Performance scores were insane. Cinebench R11.5 gave a score of 11.27 as compared with 5.96 of the AMD FX-8150 and 6.79 of Core i7-2600K. X264 HD encoding at 720p gave a whopping 58.47FPS (FX-8150 @ 36.76). WinRAR compression/decompression happened at 4282 KB/s up from 3505 KB/s of the 2600K.

If multi-threaded applications is what you use, this is the best processor for it. At ₹58,000 it is only meant for extreme power users and professionals. But worth every single penny.

Nimish Sawant

Specifications

Clock Speed: 3.3GHz; **No. of cores:** 6; **Socket:** LGA 2011; **TDP:** 130W; **Lithography:** 32nm

Contact

Intel

Web site: www.intel.com

Email: sasupport@mailbox.intel.com

Contact: N.A.

Price: ₹58,000

9.0/10

Features 8.0
Performance 9.0
Build Quality 0.0
Value for Money 8.0

Specifications

Screen: 14-inch display, 1366x768 resolution / **CPU:** 2.8-GHz i7- 2640M / **RAM:** 8 GB DDR3 / **HDD:** 750 GB / **GPU:** NVIDIA GeForce GT 520M / **OS:** Windows 7 Ultimate / **Ports:** 1 x USB 2.0, 1 x USB 3.0, HDMI, Mini Display Port, card reader, ethernet, optical drive, headphone, mic / **Weight:** 2.03-kg

Contact

Dell India Pvt. Ltd.

Website: www.dell.co.in

Phone: 1800 425 4047

Price: ₹66,900

7.0/10

Features 7.0
Performance 8.0
Build Quality 7.0
Value for Money 6.0

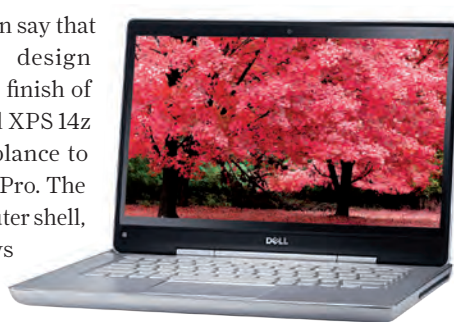
Dell XPS 14z

Style, elegance, and power packed performance

We can say that the design and finish of Dell XPS 14z

sees a stark resemblance to the Apple MacBook Pro. The smooth aluminum outer shell, the small arrow keys and the keyboard flanking speakers are all reminiscent

of the Apple MacBook Pro. The Dell XPS 14z laptop has a pretty study build thanks to the aluminum and magnesium body. The Dell XPS 14z's chiclet styled keyboard is a treat to type with. The backlight is not only at the edges of the keys but also the letters are backlight too. The large trackpad is quite sensitive and ensures easy navigation. The



mouse buttons too are discrete and give good tactile feedback. Dell has managed to nail the typing and navigating experience on the Dell XPS 14z.

The Dell XPS 14z laptop sports an LG Shuriken display, which crams a 14-inch display into 13-inch form factor; the display is edge-to-edge resulting in a very thin black bezel. However, the

resolution on the Dell XPS 14z is a let down at a disappointing 1366 x 768. Connectivity ports provided are sufficient but the placement of the ports would leave many people miffed. The PC Mark Vantage score was 7675, the 3D Mark 06 score was 5394. An attractive design, above-average performance and good battery life makes the Dell XPS 14z laptop one of the better notebooks available in the market now. Had Dell packed in a better display, the Dell XPS 14z would have been a serious competitor to the likes of MacBook Pro 13-inch. Having said that, the Dell XPS 14z will have no problems handling your day-to-day tasks and with discrete graphics it has enough grunt for light gamers.

Aniruddh Subramanian